GRADE 6 ELA

Informational Text and Research Skills

150 Multiple-Choice Questions

50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Skills covered

Central idea and summary; evidence and inference; text structure; vocabulary in context; author’s purpose; evaluating claims; comparing evidence; scientific reasoning; source credibility; and research practices.

Includes ten original nonfiction passages. The answer key is arranged in numerical question order (1–150), and each entry was validated against the final randomized option order.

Passage 1: City Trees, Cooler Streets **(Informational article)**

On summer afternoons, streets with many trees often feel cooler than streets covered mostly by pavement. A tree's leaves provide shade, blocking some sunlight from heating sidewalks and buildings. Trees also release water vapor through a process called transpiration. As that water evaporates, it can cool the surrounding air. The amount of cooling depends on factors such as the tree's size, the amount of water available, and the layout of the street. Trees cannot solve every problem caused by hot weather, but planting and caring for them can make neighborhoods more comfortable. City planners often prioritize areas with little shade, especially where older adults, young children, and people without air conditioning may be more vulnerable to heat.

1. [Easy] What do tree leaves provide on sunny streets?

A. Extra pavement for pedestrians

B. Shade that blocks some sunlight

C. A surface that stores heat

D. A barrier that stops all wind

2. [Easy] What is transpiration?

A. The transfer of pollen by insects

B. The release of water vapor from plants

C. The movement of soil downhill

D. The process of turning leaves into seeds

3. [Easy] Which places are often prioritized for tree planting?

A. Places where no one lives or works

B. Streets used only by delivery trucks

C. Neighborhoods with little shade

D. Areas already covered by dense forests

4. [Easy] According to the passage, what can trees help make more comfortable?

A. Indoor rooms without windows

B. Neighborhoods during hot weather

C. Buildings during earthquakes

D. Roads during heavy snowfall

5. [Easy] Which factor can affect how much a tree cools an area?

A. The tree's size

B. The color of nearby cars alone

C. The number of street signs

D. The age of the sidewalk paint

6. [Medium] Why does the author explain both shade and transpiration?

A. To compare trees with air-conditioning machines

B. To describe two ways trees can reduce heat

C. To show that leaves prevent all evaporation

D. To argue that trees work only at night

7. [Medium] What does the phrase “more vulnerable to heat” mean?

A. More able to cool a street

B. Less likely to notice sunlight

C. More likely to be harmed by high temperatures

D. More interested in planting trees

8. [Medium] Which statement best expresses the central idea?

A. Trees eliminate all dangers associated with hot weather

B. Every city street should be covered completely by trees

C. Only older adults benefit from shaded streets

D. Trees can help cool neighborhoods, though their effects depend on conditions

9. [Medium] Why does the passage mention people without air conditioning?

A. To claim that air conditioning should be banned

B. To explain why shade can be especially valuable to some residents

C. To suggest that trees cool only indoor spaces

D. To show that planting trees is too expensive

10. [Medium] Which evidence would best help a city evaluate a new tree-planting project?

A. A photograph of one tree on planting day

B. The number of cars painted green

C. A list of the most popular tree names

D. Temperature readings from shaded and unshaded streets over time

11. [Hard] Which conclusion is most consistent with the passage?

A. Tree size is the only factor that determines cooling

B. Cities should stop using other heat-reduction strategies once trees are planted

C. Planting one tree guarantees that a neighborhood will avoid heat illness

D. Tree planting is useful but should be planned for local conditions

12. [Hard] How does the final sentence affect the passage?

A. It proves that all residents experience heat in the same way

B. It introduces a disagreement about the color of leaves

C. It connects the environmental benefit to community needs and priorities

D. It changes the topic from trees to forest animals

13. [Hard] Which claim would require evidence beyond this passage?

A. A particular tree species will reduce a street's temperature by exactly five degrees

B. Transpiration can cool surrounding air

C. Tree care matters after planting

D. Trees can provide shade

14. [Hard] Why does the author say trees cannot solve every hot-weather problem?

A. To avoid overstating their benefits

B. To suggest that trees make streets hotter

C. To show that weather cannot be studied

D. To argue that shade has no value

15. [Hard] Which plan best applies the passage's reasoning?

A. Map shade gaps and heat risks, then select suitable trees and monitor results

B. Judge success only by counting trees on the planting day

C. Plant the same tree species everywhere without checking conditions

D. Remove existing trees to make room for more pavement

Passage 2: Why Bees Visit Flowers **(Science explainer)**

When a bee visits a flower, it is usually collecting nectar, pollen, or both. Nectar provides sugar-rich energy, while pollen contains proteins and other nutrients. As a bee moves between flowers, grains of pollen may stick to its body and be carried to another flower of the same species. This transfer can help the plant produce seeds. Not every visit results in pollination: the pollen must reach the appropriate part of a compatible flower. Flower shape, color, scent, and the time of day can influence which pollinators visit. Bees are important pollinators for many crops and wild plants, but they are part of a larger community that can include butterflies, moths, birds, bats, and other animals.

16. [Easy] What does nectar mainly provide to bees?

A. Mineral soil for roots

B. A place to build nests

C. Hard outer shells

D. Sugar-rich energy

17. [Easy] What does pollen contain?

A. Proteins and other nutrients

B. The flower's roots

C. Only water and no nutrients

D. The material used to make petals

18. [Easy] How can bees carry pollen between flowers?

A. Pollen grains may stick to their bodies

B. They carry pollen in a paper bag

C. They move seeds from underground

D. They dissolve pollen into nectar

19. [Easy] What can pollination help a plant produce?

A. Bark

B. Mineral particles

C. Rain clouds

D. Seeds

20. [Easy] Which animal is also named as a pollinator?

A. Butterfly

B. Earthworm

C. Salmon

D. House mouse

21. [Medium] Why does the author explain that not every flower visit results in pollination?

A. To suggest that bees rarely visit flowers

B. To prove that nectar has no value to bees

C. To clarify that pollen must reach the right part of a compatible flower

D. To show that all plants reproduce in exactly the same way

22. [Medium] What is the relationship between nectar and pollen in the passage?

A. They are two names for the same substance

B. They provide different resources to visiting bees

C. Neither contributes to a bee's needs

D. Both are produced by bees rather than flowers

23. [Medium] What can influence which pollinators visit a flower?

A. Its shape, color, scent, and timing

B. The color of the soil in every nearby field

C. The number of seeds already underground

D. Only the height of the nearest building

24. [Medium] Which statement best summarizes the passage?

A. All plants depend exclusively on bees for pollination

B. Bees collect floral resources and can transfer pollen, helping many plants reproduce

C. Pollination occurs whenever any animal touches any flower

D. Bees visit flowers only to rest and avoid predators

25. [Medium] Why does the author list birds, bats, and other pollinators?

A. To show that bees are important but not the only pollinators

B. To explain why bees cannot carry pollen

C. To suggest that all pollinators visit flowers at night

D. To argue that birds produce nectar

26. [Hard] Which observation would best support the claim that a bee species pollinates a crop?

A. A photograph shows the bee resting on a leaf far from flowers

B. A list shows that bees and crops live on the same continent

C. Researchers observe it transferring compatible pollen and measure resulting fruit or seed production

D. A farmer reports that the crop is green

27. [Hard] Which inference is best supported?

A. Flower scent has no relationship to pollinator visits

B. Any insect that visits a flower guarantees seed production

C. Pollination depends on more than simply visiting a flower

D. Pollen is useful only as food for bees

28. [Hard] How does the passage balance its discussion of bees?

A. It focuses only on the dangers of insects

B. It explains their value while acknowledging other pollinators and conditions for pollination

C. It presents every flower visit as successful pollination

D. It claims bees are unimportant and should be avoided

29. [Hard] Which claim is too broad based on the passage?

A. Many crops benefit from bee pollination

B. Flower traits can influence pollinator visits

C. Every crop plant can be pollinated only by bees

D. Pollen transfer can help plants produce seeds

30. [Hard] What is the most reasonable conclusion about protecting pollination?

A. Protecting bees alone guarantees every plant will reproduce

B. Removing other pollinators would improve all crops

C. Supporting diverse pollinators and suitable habitats can benefit plant reproduction

D. Flowering plants do not need animals to transfer pollen

Passage 3: How a Public Library Changed (Community profile)

For many years, the Oak Street Library was known mainly as a quiet place to borrow books. When fewer residents visited, the library team asked people what would make the building more useful. Residents suggested evening homework help, computer access, and workshops on practical skills. The library began offering these services in stages. Volunteers helped students after school, while staff taught visitors how to use online forms and search for reliable information. Attendance increased, but the library did not stop lending books. Instead, it added services while protecting quiet areas for reading and study. The change showed that a public institution can respond to new needs without abandoning its original purpose.

31. [Easy] What was the Oak Street Library mainly known for at first?

A. A quiet place to borrow books

B. A sports center with a swimming pool

C. A clinic that treated injuries

D. A shop that sold school uniforms

32. [Easy] What did residents request?

A. Evening homework help and computer access

B. A ban on books and reading rooms

C. A new bus station inside the building

D. A restaurant that stayed open all night

33. [Easy] Who helped students after school?

A. Traffic officers

B. Weather forecasters

C. Bridge engineers

D. Volunteers

34. [Easy] What happened to attendance after new services began?

A. It increased

B. It fell to zero

C. It stayed exactly the same according to the passage

D. The library closed permanently

35. [Easy] Did the library stop lending books?

A. Yes, it became a computer-only building

B. No, it continued lending books

C. No, but only staff could borrow books

D. Yes, it removed every book

36. [Medium] Why did the library team ask residents for suggestions?

A. To prove that residents disliked education

B. To learn which services would make the building more useful

C. To decide which books should be destroyed

D. To avoid making any changes

37. [Medium] What does “in stages” suggest about the new services?

A. They were cancelled before opening

B. They were available only during one hour

C. They were introduced gradually rather than all at once

D. They were offered only to actors on a stage

38. [Medium] Which sentence best expresses the central idea?

A. The library adapted to community needs while keeping its original role

B. Libraries should replace books with computer lessons

C. Public institutions should never change their services

D. Attendance matters more than the purpose of a library

39. [Medium] Why were quiet areas protected?

A. So computers could be removed from the building

B. So readers and students could still study while other services were offered

C. So the library could stop lending books

D. So volunteers could avoid helping students

40. [Medium] Which evidence suggests the changes met a community need?

A. The library had books before the changes

B. Some rooms remained quiet

C. The building had been called Oak Street Library for years

D. Attendance increased after the services were introduced

41. [Hard] What broader lesson does the example support?

A. A library is successful only when it stops lending books

B. An institution can adapt without abandoning its core purpose

C. Any institution should change everything when attendance drops

D. Community suggestions are always identical

42. [Hard] Which additional information would best test whether the changes improved access?

A. The number of pages in the oldest book

B. Visitor counts and service-use data before and after the changes, including different times of day

C. The paint color used on the library's sign

D. A list of nearby street names

43. [Hard] How does the author organize the passage?

A. It begins with the result and then gives unrelated animal facts

B. It compares two cities without explaining either library

C. It presents instructions for building a library

D. The passage describes an initial challenge, community feedback, changes, and results

44. [Hard] Which statement is not supported by the passage?

A. Every resident preferred the new services to borrowing books

B. Residents suggested practical services

C. Staff helped visitors use online forms

D. The library kept quiet areas for reading

45. [Hard] Why is the phrase “without abandoning its original purpose” important?

A. It shows that the new services failed

B. It emphasizes that the library added services while preserving book lending and study

C. It implies that the library's original purpose was harmful

D. It suggests residents were not consulted

Passage 4: Reading a Weather Map **(Science explainer)**

A weather map uses symbols, lines, and colors to summarize conditions across a region. Lines called isobars connect places with equal air pressure. When isobars are close together, winds are often stronger because pressure changes rapidly over a short distance. Fronts mark boundaries between air masses with different characteristics. A cold front may bring a narrow band of showers or thunderstorms, while a warm front can bring longer periods of cloud and precipitation. These are common patterns, not guarantees. Forecasters combine maps with satellite images, radar, measurements, and computer models. A map is therefore one piece of evidence, and its meaning becomes clearer when compared with other observations and updated forecasts.

46. [Easy] What do isobars connect?

A. Cities with the same population

B. Places with equal rainfall every day

C. Places with equal air pressure

D. Mountains with identical heights

47. [Easy] What do closely spaced isobars often indicate?

A. The absence of air pressure

B. No wind anywhere

C. Stronger winds

D. A guaranteed heat wave

48. [Easy] What do fronts mark?

A. Boundaries between air masses with different characteristics

B. The edges of a printed map

C. Roads used by emergency vehicles

D. Areas where rain is impossible

49. [Easy] Which tool is mentioned alongside weather maps?

A. A microscope for soil particles

B. A bridge counterweight

C. A library card

D. Radar

50. [Easy] Does a weather map provide the only evidence forecasters use?

A. Yes, no other information is needed

B. No, they combine it with other observations and models

C. Yes, but only during winter

D. No, because maps cannot show pressure

51. [Medium] Why does the author describe isobars before discussing fronts?

A. To show that weather maps are arranged by alphabet

B. To compare air pressure with population size

C. To argue that fronts are not useful

D. To explain two different kinds of information shown on weather maps

52. [Medium] What does “not guarantees” mean when describing weather patterns?

A. The patterns always happen exactly as described

B. The patterns are common but do not happen every time

C. The patterns apply only to past weather

D. The patterns are impossible to observe

53. [Medium] Why do forecasters compare maps with radar and satellite images?

A. Radar can replace all forecasts

B. Maps are never based on measurements

C. They need to make maps look more colorful

D. Different sources of evidence help them interpret conditions more accurately

54. [Medium] Which statement is the best summary?

A. Weather maps predict every storm with complete certainty

B. Weather maps organize clues about pressure and air masses, which forecasters combine with other evidence

C. Isobars show only where roads are located

D. A cold front always produces the same weather in every region

55. [Medium] What is the likely purpose of the passage?

A. To persuade readers to become bridge operators

B. To explain how to interpret basic features of weather maps

C. To tell a fictional story about a storm

D. To argue that computer models are unnecessary

56. [Hard] A map shows tightly packed isobars, but radar shows no rain. What is the best conclusion?

A. A storm is guaranteed to begin within five minutes

B. The map must be false because no rain appears

C. Tightly packed isobars mean air pressure is absent

D. Winds may be strong, but the map alone does not establish that rain is occurring

57. [Hard] Which statement best reflects the passage's view of forecasting?

A. Forecasts improve when multiple types of evidence are considered together

B. Weather patterns never vary by location

C. A single map is always more reliable than measurements

D. Forecasters should ignore updated observations

58. [Hard] How does the author qualify the descriptions of cold and warm fronts?

A. By describing typical patterns while noting they are not certain outcomes

B. By saying all fronts produce thunderstorms

C. By claiming fronts have no relationship to precipitation

D. By describing only one weather event from history

59. [Hard] Which data set would best help assess a forecast's accuracy?

A. The names of people who viewed the forecast

B. The number of pages in a weather textbook

C. Predicted conditions compared with recorded observations across several times and locations

D. The number of colors printed on the map

60. [Hard] What is the most important caution for a reader using a weather map?

A. Use isobars to determine the age of a storm

B. Assume every symbol predicts the exact weather

C. Ignore all other observations once the map is available

D. Interpret its symbols as evidence, not as a complete guarantee of what will happen

Passage 5: The Bridge That Moves **(Engineering article)**

Some bridges are designed to move so that boats can pass beneath them. A bascule bridge uses one or two sections that rotate upward, much like a seesaw. Counterweights can help balance the moving sections, reducing the effort required from the motors. Operators must coordinate traffic signals, barriers, and warning systems before opening the bridge. Sensors and regular inspections help identify wear in gears, hinges, and other parts. A movable bridge must meet two demands: it needs to carry road traffic safely when closed, and it must move reliably when water traffic requires clearance. Engineers weigh construction cost, maintenance needs, river conditions, and the amount of boat and vehicle traffic when choosing a design.

61. [Easy] Why are some bridges designed to move?

A. To let boats pass beneath them

B. To make road traffic travel faster uphill

C. To collect rainwater for gardens

D. To prevent all wind from crossing a river

62. [Easy] How does a bascule bridge move?

A. It slides beneath the riverbed

B. Its road surface melts and reforms

C. The entire bridge floats downstream

D. One or more sections rotate upward

63. [Easy] What can counterweights help do?

A. Make the bridge longer every year

B. Warn birds away from the bridge

C. Balance the moving sections

D. Measure the river's salt content

64. [Easy] What do sensors and inspections help identify?

A. The age of every driver

B. The names of passing boats

C. Wear in gears, hinges, and other parts

D. The color of nearby buildings

65. [Easy] What two demands must a movable bridge meet?

A. Carry road traffic safely and move reliably for boats

B. Use no motors and require no maintenance

C. Stay open to boats and closed to all vehicles

D. Remain underwater and support trains

66. [Medium] Why must operators coordinate signals, barriers, and warnings?

A. To make the bridge open without moving parts

B. To avoid checking the bridge's mechanical systems

C. To prevent boats from using the river

D. To manage traffic safely before the bridge opens

67. [Medium] What does “clearance” mean in this passage?

A. The amount of paint needed for the bridge

B. The distance a car travels before braking

C. The time required to build a road

D. Enough open space for a boat to pass beneath the bridge

68. [Medium] Why do engineers consider both boat and vehicle traffic?

A. The design must serve the needs of both kinds of users

B. Vehicle traffic determines the river's depth

C. Only boats affect how a bridge is built

D. The two types of traffic never use the same bridge

69. [Medium] Which statement best summarizes the passage?

A. All bridges must rotate to allow boats through

B. Bridge design depends only on construction cost

C. Movable bridges use mechanical systems and safety procedures to serve road and water traffic

D. Counterweights remove the need for inspections

70. [Medium] Which factor is named as part of choosing a bridge design?

A. The number of books in nearby libraries

B. The kinds of flowers on the riverbank only

C. The favorite color of local residents

D. River conditions

71. [Hard] What trade-off must engineers consider?

A. Sensors make all future maintenance unnecessary

B. Reliable movement and safe road use must be balanced with cost and maintenance

C. The cheapest design is always the most reliable

D. A bridge should serve boats even if road traffic becomes unsafe

72. [Hard] Which evidence would best indicate that a bridge's warning system is effective?

A. A photograph of the bridge on a sunny day

B. A list of nearby restaurants

C. The number of boats painted blue

D. Records showing barriers and signals activate correctly before each opening

73. [Hard] How does the passage connect engineering and public safety?

A. It explains that mechanical design, monitoring, and coordinated procedures all help reduce risk

B. It describes safety as less important than speed

C. It suggests that warning systems are unrelated to bridge operation

D. It claims safety depends only on the bridge's appearance

74. [Hard] Which claim goes beyond the evidence in the passage?

A. Counterweights can help balance moving sections

B. Sensors can help identify wear

C. Every bascule bridge can operate safely without human oversight

D. Designers consider traffic and river conditions

75. [Hard] Why does the author list cost, maintenance, river conditions, and traffic?

A. To show that bridge design requires considering several interacting factors

B. To argue that one factor always determines the design

C. To suggest engineers do not need to test designs

D. To provide a complete history of every bridge type

Passage 6: Monarchs on the Move **(Nature report)**

Monarch butterflies travel between seasonal habitats in a migration that can span thousands of kilometers. The journey is unusual because the butterflies that arrive at a destination may not be the same individuals that began the trip. Several generations can be involved in the annual cycle. During migration, monarchs need suitable resting places and sources of nectar. Their caterpillars depend on milkweed plants for food, so the availability of milkweed affects where monarchs can reproduce. Habitat loss, extreme weather, and other pressures can make the journey harder. Communities can help by planting native milkweed and nectar-producing flowers suited to local conditions. A single garden cannot solve every threat, but connected patches of habitat can provide useful resources along a route.

76. [Easy] What is unusual about monarch migration?

A. One butterfly always completes the entire cycle alone

B. Monarchs migrate only a few meters

C. The butterflies never need places to rest

D. Several generations may take part in the annual journey

77. [Easy] What do monarch caterpillars depend on for food?

A. Milkweed plants

B. River stones

C. Tree bark only

D. Pine cones

78. [Easy] What do adult monarchs need during migration?

A. Only deep water

B. Resting places and nectar sources

C. Artificial light every hour

D. A supply of mineral soil

79. [Easy] Which threat is mentioned in the passage?

A. Excessive soil testing

B. Bridge movement

C. Habitat loss

D. Too many libraries

80. [Easy] What can communities plant to help monarchs?

A. Trees with no leaves

B. Crops that produce no nectar

C. Only nonflowering lawn grass

D. Native milkweed and suitable nectar-producing flowers

81. [Medium] Why does milkweed availability affect monarch reproduction?

A. Milkweed prevents all extreme weather

B. Adult butterflies build nests inside milkweed roots

C. Caterpillars depend on milkweed for food

D. Milkweed produces the butterflies' wings

82. [Medium] What does “connected patches of habitat” suggest?

A. Habitats must be covered by pavement

B. Butterflies should never leave one garden

C. One huge garden is the only possible solution

D. Separate useful areas can support movement along a migration route

83. [Medium] Why does the author mention that the butterflies arriving may differ from those that began the journey?

A. To suggest that migration is a human activity

B. To claim that monarchs do not reproduce

C. To show that every butterfly gets lost

D. To explain that migration can involve multiple generations

84. [Medium] Which statement best summarizes the passage?

A. Monarch migration depends on resources along the route and faces several environmental pressures

B. Monarchs migrate because they avoid all flowers

C. Only adult monarchs need habitat

D. One garden can remove every threat to monarchs

85. [Medium] Why does the author say a single garden cannot solve every threat?

A. To claim that monarchs do not visit gardens

B. To show that local help is useful but limited in scope

C. To discourage people from planting flowers

D. To prove that habitat never affects migration

86. [Hard] Which community plan best follows the passage's reasoning?

A. Plant one isolated garden and assume migration is fully protected

B. Create connected native planting areas and monitor whether they provide seasonal resources

C. Plant flowers without checking whether they suit local conditions

D. Remove milkweed to encourage monarchs to find other food

87. [Hard] What conclusion is best supported about migration?

A. Every generation follows an identical route without environmental influence

B. Monarchs can complete migration without resting or feeding

C. Habitat loss affects only butterflies that never migrate

D. A long journey depends on suitable resources at multiple points, not just at its destination

88. [Hard] Which research would best test whether a habitat corridor helps monarchs?

A. Measure the height of nearby buildings only

B. Compare monarch use and survival in connected areas with similar unconnected areas over time

C. Count the colors of flowers in a single garden once

D. Ask visitors whether they like butterflies

89. [Hard] How does the passage balance local action with wider threats?

A. It claims that planting flowers prevents extreme weather

B. It says local action is useless and should stop

C. It focuses entirely on the history of butterfly names

D. It presents planting as helpful while acknowledging that it cannot solve every pressure

90. [Hard] Which claim is not supported?

A. Caterpillars depend on milkweed

B. Nectar sources can help migrating butterflies

C. Extreme weather can make migration harder

D. A garden with milkweed guarantees that every monarch will survive migration

Passage 7: From Seed to Seedling (Science explainer)

A seed contains a young plant and stored resources that can support early growth. Many seeds begin germination when they receive enough water and oxygen and experience a suitable temperature. Water can soften the seed coat and activate processes inside the seed. The first root usually grows downward, anchoring the plant and absorbing water. A shoot grows upward toward light. Some seeds need additional conditions, such as exposure to cold or a period of dormancy, before they germinate. A seedling's later growth depends on factors including light, nutrients, water, and space. Giving a seed more water than it can use does not necessarily help; waterlogged soil can reduce the oxygen available to roots.

91. [Easy] What does a seed contain?

A. Only water and no living material

B. A fully grown tree

C. A collection of flower petals

D. A young plant and stored resources

92. [Easy] Which conditions can help many seeds begin germination?

A. Dry soil and no air

B. Enough water and oxygen and a suitable temperature

C. Only fertilizer, with no water

D. Complete darkness for every seed

93. [Easy] Which part usually grows downward first?

A. The fruit

B. The seed coat only

C. The root

D. The flower

94. [Easy] What does the shoot grow toward?

A. The coldest possible place

B. The center of the Earth

C. Light

D. Salt water only

95. [Easy] What can waterlogged soil reduce?

A. The amount of sunlight outside

B. The length of a day

C. Oxygen available to roots

D. The number of seed coats in a packet

96. [Medium] Why does water help a seed begin germination?

A. It makes every seed germinate regardless of temperature

B. It immediately provides all the energy the plant will ever need

C. It replaces the need for oxygen in every seed

D. It can soften the seed coat and activate processes inside the seed

97. [Medium] What does the passage imply about giving a seed extra water?

A. The more water a seed receives, the faster it always grows

B. More water is not always better if it limits oxygen

C. Water prevents all seed coats from opening

D. Water is unnecessary once a seed is planted

98. [Medium] Why might some seeds need exposure to cold or dormancy?

A. Cold always destroys the young plant

B. Certain seeds require additional conditions before they germinate

C. All seeds must freeze before growing

D. Dormancy means the seed has no living material

99. [Medium] Which statement best summarizes the passage?

A. Roots grow upward toward light while shoots grow downward

B. Seeds grow only when they receive the greatest possible amount of water

C. Germination depends on suitable conditions, and later growth depends on ongoing resources

D. Every seed follows exactly the same germination requirements

100. [Medium] Which factor affects a seedling's later growth?

A. The shape of a nearby fence only

B. The number of labels on a seed packet

C. Available light

D. The color of a gardener's shoes

101. [Hard] A seed is in warm, wet soil but does not germinate. What is the best conclusion?

A. The seed needs to be covered with more water until submerged

B. Other requirements or dormancy may explain why it has not germinated

C. Warmth and water guarantee germination for every seed

D. The seed must be dead because it has not sprouted immediately

102. [Hard] Why is the passage organized from seed contents to germination and then seedling growth?

A. It presents a problem and then a fictional solution

B. It lists gardening tools in order of price

C. It follows the process from the beginning of growth to the plant's later needs

D. It compares unrelated plants by their flower colors

103. [Hard] Which experiment would best test the effect of water amount on germination?

A. Use different seed species, soils, temperatures, and water amounts at once

B. Use similar seeds under the same conditions except for measured water amounts, then compare results

C. Water one seed once and draw a conclusion about all seeds

D. Give every seed a different amount of light and do not record it

104. [Hard] What does the passage suggest about plant care?

A. Light matters only before a seed sprouts

B. All plant growth problems can be solved by adding water

C. Roots do not need oxygen after germination

D. Conditions should be balanced rather than maximized without limit

105. [Hard] Which statement is best supported by the text?

A. A seed's requirements can vary, so germination conditions should suit the type of seed

B. Seeds use no stored resources during early growth

C. A seedling's growth is determined only by its seed coat

D. Every seed needs cold exposure before it can grow

Passage 8: What Soil Reveals (Earth science article)

Soil is a mixture of mineral particles, organic matter, water, air, and living organisms. The sizes of its mineral particles affect how water moves through it. Sandy soil has relatively large particles and often drains quickly. Clay has very small particles and can hold water tightly, though compacted clay may drain poorly. Loam contains a useful balance of sand, silt, clay, and organic matter for many garden plants. Soil also supports decomposers, which break down dead material and return nutrients to the environment. A soil sample from one location may differ from a sample only a short distance away because of slope, vegetation, drainage, and past land use. Observations and tests help explain these differences.

106. [Easy] Which materials are part of soil?

A. Mineral particles, organic matter, water, air, and living organisms

B. Only sand and water

C. Only dead leaves and stones

D. Metal, glass, and plastic only

107. [Easy] Which soil type often drains quickly?

A. Waterlogged soil

B. Solid rock

C. Clay soil in every condition

D. Sandy soil

108. [Easy] What can clay do with water?

A. Turn it into sunlight

B. Remove every nutrient from plants

C. Hold it tightly

D. Prevent all roots from growing in every case

109. [Easy] What is loam described as having?

A. Only very large particles

B. A useful balance of sand, silt, clay, and organic matter

C. Only clay and no air

D. No organic matter

110. [Easy] What do decomposers do?

A. Make soil from glass

B. Break down dead material and return nutrients

C. Stop all plant growth

D. Turn rain into mineral particles

111. [Medium] Why can two nearby soil samples differ?

A. Soil is identical at every location

B. Only the names of the locations matter

C. Soil changes only when people paint the ground

D. Slope, vegetation, drainage, and past land use can vary

112. [Medium] What does “compact” clay mean in context?

A. The soil contains no mineral particles

B. The clay has been changed into sand

C. The clay is always dry and cracked

D. Clay particles are pressed closely together

113. [Medium] Why is the balance of materials in loam useful for many plants?

A. Loam prevents all drainage

B. Loam is made entirely of decomposers

C. Different components contribute different properties to the soil

D. Loam contains no water and needs no nutrients

114. [Medium] Which statement best summarizes the passage?

A. All soil types drain water at the same rate

B. Soil composition varies and affects water movement and plant support

C. Soil differences are caused only by the weather on the sampling day

D. Soil is made only of minerals

115. [Medium] What role do decomposers play in soil?

A. They help return nutrients to the environment

B. They remove all organic matter permanently

C. They create rainfall directly

D. They prevent dead material from breaking down

116. [Hard] A garden's soil stays wet long after rain. Which investigation is most useful?

A. Identify the tallest plant without examining the soil

B. Count the number of nearby streetlights

C. Measure the color of garden tools

D. Check soil texture, compaction, drainage, and the site's slope

117. [Hard] Why does the author mention that samples can differ over a short distance?

A. To show that soil tests are always inaccurate

B. To argue that plants grow only in one soil type

C. To caution readers against assuming one sample represents an entire area

D. To prove that land use never affects soil

118. [Hard] Which claim would require more evidence than the passage provides?

A. Sandy soil often drains quickly

B. Soil contains living organisms

C. Every garden with loam will produce the same crop yield

D. Slope can influence soil differences

119. [Hard] How does the passage connect soil composition to plant growth?

A. It focuses only on the appearance of garden soil

B. It describes plants as the main cause of all mineral particles

C. It explains that particle sizes, drainage, and nutrients affect growing conditions

D. It claims soil composition has no effect on plants

120. [Hard] Which method best supports a reliable comparison of two soil sites?

A. Choose samples based on which looks darker and stop there

B. Collect samples systematically from both sites and use the same tests

C. Test one sample after adding fertilizer and the other without recording changes

D. Take one handful from one site and compare it with a photograph of the other

Passage 9: Choosing Reliable Online Sources **(Media literacy guide)**

A search engine can return thousands of pages, but the first result is not automatically the most reliable. Readers should ask who created a page, what evidence it provides, when it was updated, and whether its purpose is to inform, persuade, entertain, or sell. A claim supported by named experts, traceable data, and links to original research is easier to check than a claim based only on anonymous comments. Comparing independent sources can reveal whether a statement is widely supported or disputed. Readers should also distinguish the date a page was published from the date of the events it describes. A polished design may make a page look professional, but appearance alone cannot prove accuracy.

121. [Easy] Does the first search result automatically have the most reliable information?

A. Yes, if the page has a colorful design

B. Yes, search engines verify every claim

C. No, readers should evaluate it

D. No, because all online pages are false

122. [Easy] Which question should a reader ask about a webpage?

A. Who created it?

B. What color is the reader's desk?

C. How many windows are in the author's house?

D. What is the page's background music?

123. [Easy] What can named experts and traceable data help readers do?

A. Make a page load faster

B. Guarantee that the page is entertaining

C. Check a claim

D. Remove the need to compare sources

124. [Easy] What should readers distinguish?

A. The page's publication date and the date of the events it describes

B. A writer's name and the reader's age

C. The page title and the color of the browser

D. A website's font and screen size

125. [Easy] Can a polished design prove accuracy?

A. No, because accurate pages never use design

B. Yes, professional design guarantees truth

C. Yes, if the page uses several colors

D. No, appearance alone cannot prove accuracy

126. [Medium] Why is it useful to compare independent sources?

A. It can show whether a claim is supported widely or disputed

B. It makes checking evidence unnecessary

C. It reveals the author's favorite color

D. It ensures every source will agree

127. [Medium] What does it mean for data to be “traceable”?

A. Readers can follow it back to its origin or supporting material

B. The data is written in a decorative font

C. The data is always recent and correct

D. The data has been hidden from readers

128. [Medium] Why does the author list several possible purposes of a page?

A. Every page has exactly the same purpose

B. A reader should consider whether the page aims to inform, persuade, entertain, or sell

C. Only entertaining pages contain facts

D. A page's purpose can be determined by its title alone

129. [Medium] Which source is easier to verify, according to the passage?

A. A page that says readers should not check other sources

B. A claim linked to original research and supported by named experts

C. An anonymous comment with no evidence

D. A claim with no date and no supporting links

130. [Medium] What is the central idea of the guide?

A. A professional-looking page needs no fact-checking

B. Online information should be evaluated using evidence, authorship, date, and purpose

C. Search engines return only unreliable sources

D. The newest webpage is always correct

131. [Hard] A page quotes a study but links to no study and names no researchers. What is the best next step?

A. Look for the original study and compare the claim with independent sources

B. Reject every statement on the internet immediately

C. Accept the claim because it mentions research

D. Judge accuracy by the page's logo alone

132. [Hard] Why can the date of an event differ from a page's publication date?

A. Every event happens on the day it is published

B. The publication date is always hidden by law

C. A page may report on something that happened earlier

D. Websites cannot describe past events

133. [Hard] Which feature provides the weakest evidence of reliability by itself?

A. Named experts whose work can be checked

B. A link to original data

C. Agreement among independent, credible sources

D. A polished visual design

134. [Hard] How does the passage encourage critical thinking?

A. It gives readers questions and checks to apply before accepting claims

B. It says every source is equally reliable

C. It recommends choosing sources that confirm existing beliefs

D. It tells readers to trust the first result

135. [Hard] Which research practice best follows the guide?

A. Use a single anonymous post as final proof

B. Ignore a source's purpose if its design looks professional

C. Trace claims to original evidence, check dates and authors, and compare independent sources

D. Choose the result with the most dramatic headline

Passage 10: A Neighborhood Water Plan **(Civic information article)**

After two dry summers, residents of Brookside formed a group to reduce unnecessary water use. They first examined household water bills and identified common sources of waste, including leaking taps and watering lawns during the hottest part of the day. The group shared repair instructions and encouraged residents to water gardens early in the morning, when less water is lost to evaporation. A local school installed rain barrels to collect roof runoff for its garden. The group tracked water use over the next year, but it also recorded rainfall because weather affects demand. The results suggested that several small actions together could reduce consumption. The group cautioned that one year's data could not prove the same savings would occur under every set of conditions.

136. [Easy] Why did Brookside residents form a water-use group?

A. They wanted to increase leaks in homes

B. They wanted to replace all gardens with pavement

C. They planned to close the local school

D. After two dry summers, they wanted to reduce unnecessary water use

137. [Easy] What household problem did the group identify?

A. Leaking taps

B. Incorrect weather-map symbols

C. Loose bridge counterweights

D. Broken library shelves

138. [Easy] When did the group recommend watering gardens?

A. Whenever the pavement is hottest

B. Only at midnight during winter

C. At the hottest part of the day

D. Early in the morning

139. [Easy] What did the school install to collect roof runoff?

A. Solar telescopes

B. Rain barrels

C. A pollen laboratory

D. A movable bridge

140. [Easy] Why did the group record rainfall?

A. Rainfall determines the library's opening hours

B. Weather has no relationship to water use

C. Weather affects water demand

D. Rainfall changes the color of household bills

141. [Medium] Why did the group examine household bills first?

A. To identify common patterns and possible sources of waste

B. To prove every household used the same amount of water

C. To measure how many flowers grew in the school

D. To decide which residents should move away

142. [Medium] How can watering early reduce water loss?

A. Water becomes solid before sunrise

B. Plants stop needing water in the morning

C. Less water may be lost to evaporation than during the hottest part of the day

D. Early watering prevents all leaks

143. [Medium] What does the passage suggest about combining small actions?

A. Every household must use exactly the same method

B. Small actions never affect total use

C. Several actions together may reduce water consumption

D. Only rain barrels can reduce water use

144. [Medium] Why did the group track water use over a full year?

A. To avoid collecting any information about weather

B. To prove that one day's data is enough

C. To observe changes over time rather than rely on a single measurement

D. To make the group look larger

145. [Medium] Why does the group caution that one year's data has limits?

A. Water demand never changes from year to year

B. Savings may differ under other weather and usage conditions

C. Rainfall cannot be measured

D. The group did not measure water use at all

146. [Hard] Which analysis would best help determine whether the plan reduced water use?

A. Compare water use before and after while accounting for rainfall and other relevant changes

B. Compare one household's bill with a different household's bill without context

C. Measure rainfall once and ignore water-use records

D. Count the number of rain barrels and assume consumption fell

147. [Hard] What is the role of the final sentence?

A. It limits the conclusion by acknowledging that results may not apply to every condition

B. It proves that rainfall never affects demand

C. It introduces a new topic unrelated to water

D. It claims the plan failed completely

148. [Hard] Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

A. Rain barrels alone will solve every drought

B. Water conservation is useful only after two dry summers

C. The group proved identical savings are possible every year

D. A combination of repairs, changed habits, and rain collection may help reduce use

149. [Hard] Which additional evidence would strengthen the group's findings?

A. A photograph of a rain barrel without measurements

B. Several years of water-use data with rainfall and household changes recorded

C. A list of the group members' favorite drinks

D. A record of the school's paint colors

150. [Hard] How does the passage model responsible use of evidence?

A. It reports a promising result while acknowledging limits in the data

B. It treats one year's result as proof for all future years

C. It ignores weather when explaining water demand

D. It assumes every household followed the advice

Answer Key — Numerical Sequence

Answers are listed strictly from Question 1 through Question 150. Each letter matches the final randomized options.

1. B
2. B
3. C
4. B
5. A
6. B
7. C
8. D
9. B
10. D
11. D
12. C
13. A
14. A
15. A
16. D
17. A
18. A
19. D
20. A
21. C
22. B
23. A
24. B
25. A
26. C
27. C
28. B
29. C
30. C
31. A
32. A
33. D
34. A
51. D
52. B
53. D
54. B
55. B
56. D
57. A
58. A
59. C
60. D
61. A
62. D
63. C
64. C
65. A
66. D
67. D
68. A
69. C
70. D
71. B
72. D
73. A
74. C
75. A
76. D
77. A
78. B
79. C
80. D
81. C
82. D
83. D
84. A
101. B
102. C
103. B
104. D
105. A
106. A
107. D
108. C
109. B
110. B
111. D
112. D
113. C
114. B
115. A
116. D
117. C
118. C
119. C
120. B
121. C
122. A
123. C
124. A
125. D
126. A
127. A
128. B
129. B
130. B
131. A
132. C
133. D
134. A

35. B
36. B
37. C
38. A
39. B
40. D
41. B
42. B
43. D
44. A
45. B
46. C
47. C
48. A
49. D
50. B
85. B
86. B
87. D
88. B
89. D
90. D
91. D
92. B
93. C
94. C
95. C
96. D
97. B
98. B
99. C
100. C
135. C
136. D
137. A
138. D
139. B
140. C
141. A
142. C
143. C
144. C
145. B
146. A
147. A
148. D
149. B
150. A